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Potter

1.5.1 Potter

Potter's wheel

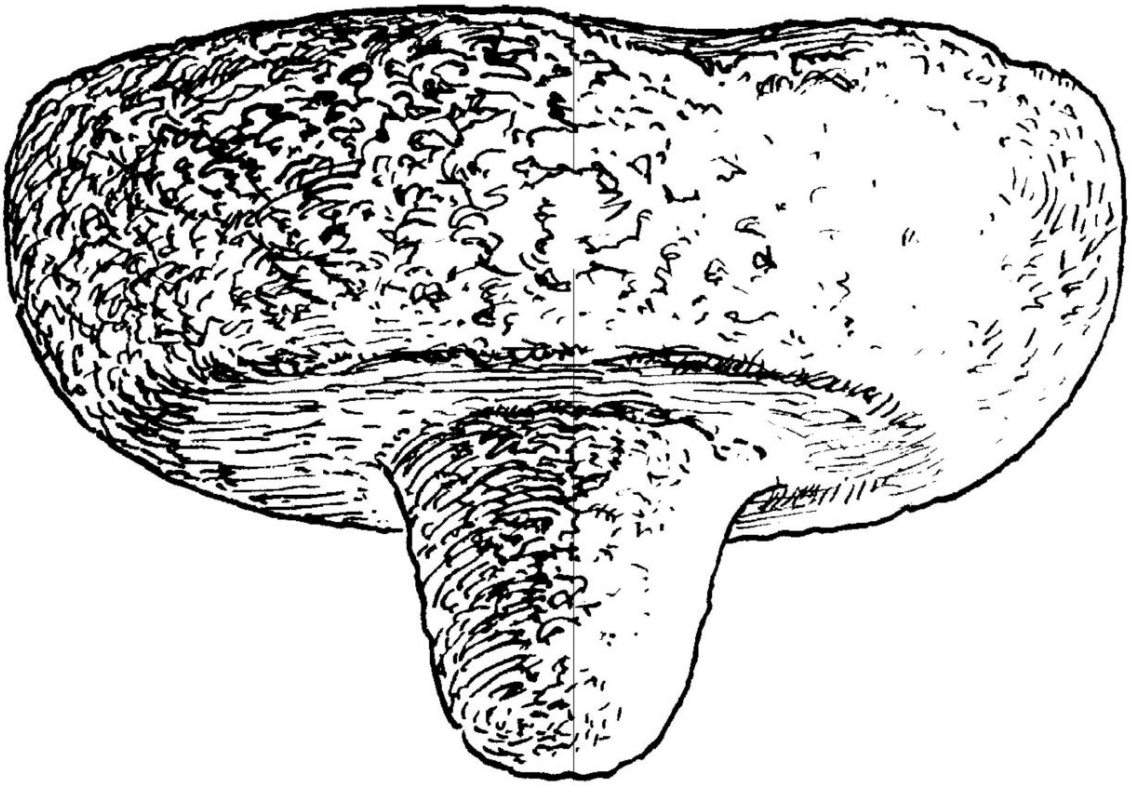
1.5.1.1 Potter's wheel

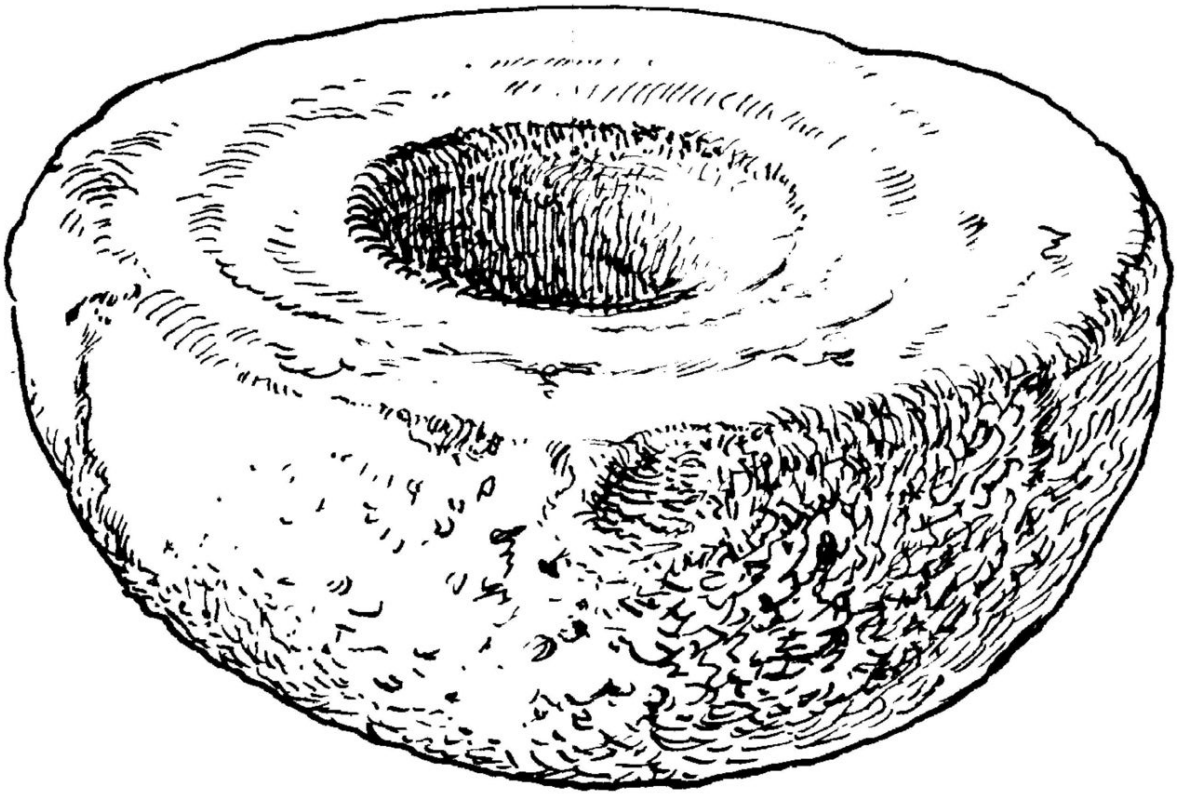
References:

Hebrew אָבְנַיִם (ʼovnayim) JER 18:3

Greek τροχός (trochos) SIR 38:29

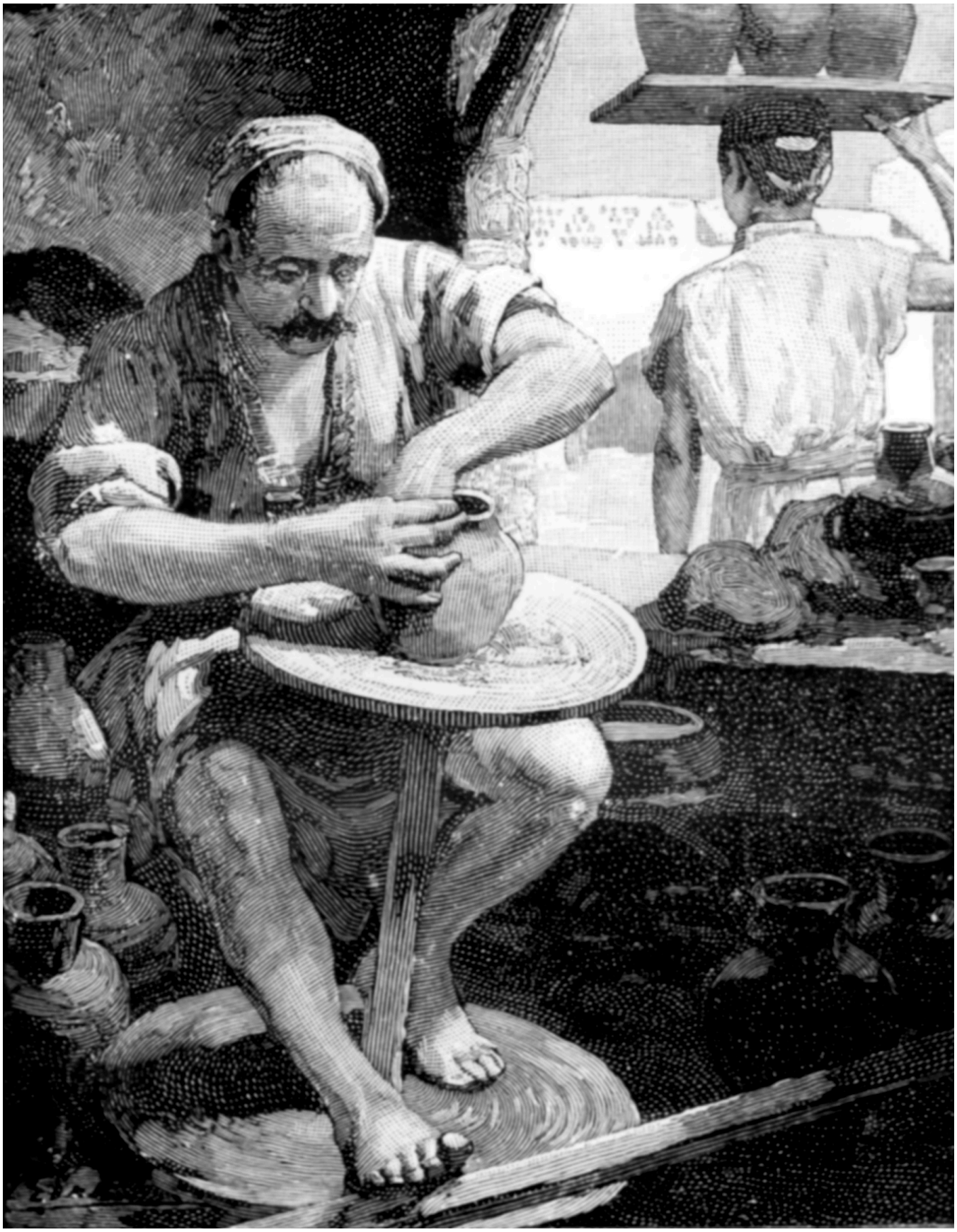
Description:





Potter's wheel (Old Testament times) (© Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, Stuttgart by United Bible Societies)In Old Testament times the potter's wheel was a flat, horizontal wheel made of stone. On the underside of the stone there was a pointed projection. This projection sat in an indentation on a stationary lower stone and served as an axis around which the upper stone turned. The stone was turned by hand or perhaps by a person other than the potter. In intertestamental and New Testament times the construction was different. An upper wheel, made of wood, was connected by a shaft to a second, larger wheel situated below. The upper wheel was at a height convenient for the potter to work when seated.

Usage:



Potter turning wheel with his foot (New Testament times) (The Pictorial New Testament, The Religious Tract Society 1881, Public domain)Clay was placed in the center of the upper wheel. The wheel was turned by hand or by foot. In the latter period, the spinning of the lower, heavier wheel caused the upper one to spin also. The potter used his fingers to form the spinning clay into the desired shape. See SIR 38:29: "It is the same with the potter, sitting at his wheel and turning it with his feet ..." (GNT).

Translation:

The context of JER 18:1; JER 18:2; JER 18:3; JER 18:4 makes it clear that the potter is using the "wheel" to help him make clay pots. However, if it is felt that "wheel" would be misleading, translators may say "work table."

Glue

1.5.1.2 Glue

Reference:

Greek συγκολλάω (sugkollaō (verb)) SIR 22:9

Description and usage:

Glue is an adhesive substance used to stick one thing to another.

Translation:

While nearly all languages have a word for adhesive substances, the Greek text of SIR 22:7 actually uses a verb, and many translations will prefer to describe the action of sticking two things back together; for example, GNT has "Trying to teach a fool is like gluing a broken pot back together ...." Some languages may distinguish between different kinds of adhesives. The glue chosen here should be appropriate for sticking together pieces of earthenware pottery.